

Guidelines on the Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

1. Purpose and Scope

These guidelines were developed by reviewing GW's existing policies and guidance to increase clarity on the use of artificial intelligence (AI) at the GW School of Business (GWSB).¹ Some guidelines below are for all members of the GWSB community, and other guidelines are directed specifically toward staff, instructors, researchers, and students. Everyone in the GWSB community should read and understand these guidelines in their entirety. The following summary is provided for informational purposes only. In general:

- The GWSB community should use AI tools responsibly to improve work and educational outcomes.
- Instructors should provide clear instructions to students on AI tool use in the form of syllabus statements. Unless specified otherwise by an instructor, students may use AI for assignments with disclosure, documentation, and credit for tools or sources.
- GW-provided AI tools are encouraged for faculty and staff.
- When using AI tools, usage should be disclosed, cited, and checked.
- P-card purchases for AI research tools are typically reimbursable. Faculty and staff should coordinate with GW IT and/or GWSB Finance prior to making P-Card purchases of AI tools for non-research purposes.
- Certain AI tools are prohibited in various circumstances—check syllabi and details below to understand when AI tool use is prohibited.
- Avoid using sensitive data in public AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude). Sensitive data should be processed by faculty or staff using GW-provided Box AI.

Please continue reading for important information.

¹ Google Gemini and NotebookLM were used to draft and review these guidelines. Use of AI tools enabled cross-referencing against 90+ additional university AI guidelines to ensure standardization and adequate coverage.

2. Guidelines for Everyone

2.1. Automated Decisionmaking by AI Tools

- A. **Automated Decisionmaking:** Using AI to make final, automated decisions regarding student admissions, grades, hiring, financial aid, or other decisions with consequential financial or educational outcomes for human subjects must be approved by the GWSB Dean's Office [1].²
- B. **Appeal and Override:** Subjects of automated decisionmaking must be provided a straightforward way to appeal and correct AI outcomes that are demonstrably inaccurate. If an appeal process is not provided, direct complaints or appeals to the GWSB Dean's Office.

2.2. Accountability and Transparency

- A. **Plagiarism:** AI-generated content must not be presented as your own original work [2].
- B. **Disclosure:** Use of AI in your work should be disclosed in many cases [3, 4].
 - i. **Disclosure is Distinct From Authorization:** Disclosure does not authorize AI tool use where it has been otherwise prohibited.
 - ii. **Automated AI Impersonation:** No member of the GWSB community may use automated AI tools to impersonate themselves in digital communications without disclosure (i.e., use of email agents, digital twins, or similar technologies should be accompanied by clear disclosures of AI use) [5].
 - iii. **Classwork Disclosure:** Students should follow instructor guidance on disclosure of AI use for classwork. If no guidance is provided by the instructor, and AI use is authorized by the instructor, students should document and credit AI-based sources.
 - iv. **Publication Disclosure:** When publishing work, follow any publisher guidelines on disclosing AI use [5].
 - v. **Routine Use:** Routine use accompanied by human review does not require disclosure (e.g., drafting routine internal emails, suggesting synonyms, brainstorming) [3].

² AI use is *not* considered automated decisionmaking when a qualified person independently reviews the relevant AI output and exercises judgment to accept, modify, or reject the AI output.

- vi. **Consequential Use:** When using AI for consequential applications, a concise AI use disclosure is recommended (e.g., formal reports, broad external communications, written policy decisions) [3].³
- C. **Personal Responsibility:** You are ultimately responsible for all the work you submit or publish, even if AI was used to create it. You should review all AI-generated output for accuracy and potential errors, such as "hallucinations" or incorrect citations [2, 3].
- D. **Ethical Use:** AI must not be used for undisclosed impersonation of yourself or others (e.g., "deepfakes"), harassment, in violation of university policies, or for illegal activities [1, 5].

2.3. GW Data and Intellectual Property

- A. **GW-Provided Tools:** [GW-provided AI tools](#) must be used for [GW-restricted or GW-regulated data](#) [3].
 - i. **Regulated Data:** (e.g., GWIDs, student records, financial accounts) Use Box AI [6, 7].
 - ii. **Restricted Data:** (e.g., payroll, legal records, internal directories) Use Microsoft Copilot, GW Chat, Box AI, Zoom AI, Gemini, or NotebookLM [6, 7].
 - iii. **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** (e.g., names, email addresses, GWIDs, or government-issued ID numbers) Use Box AI [3, 6, 7].
 - iv. **Checking for Updates:** You should check the [Artificial Intelligence \(AI\) Evaluation & Status](#) page for updates to GW-provided tools and data classifications.
- B. **Public AI Tools:** You must not use public AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude) for restricted or regulated university data or PII [1, 3].
- C. **Protecting Community Work:** You should not input unpublished academic work, funding proposal drafts, peer or student evaluation materials, or class materials (e.g., syllabi, slide presentations, assignments, etc.) into AI tools without approval or permission from the owner of that data [3, 8].
- D. **Anonymization:** You should remove personally identifying details from data before using it with AI tools to protect individual data privacy [1, 3].

³ See footnote 1 of these guidelines for an example disclosure statement.

3. Guidelines for Instructors

3.1. AI Detection and Plagiarism Tools

The George Washington University Code of Academic Integrity applies to all academic integrity allegations.

- A. **AI Detection Tools:** AI detection tools (e.g., GPTZero) are frequently inaccurate [4, 8]. Instructors should not use AI detection tools as the basis for an academic integrity allegation.
- B. **Plagiarism Detection Tools:** Instructors may use results from GW-provided plagiarism detection tools (e.g., SafeAssign) in academic integrity allegations [4].

3.2. Reimbursement Guidelines [1, 3]

Currently, P-Card purchases of AI tools for non-research purposes are not reimbursable in many cases. However, the purchase of AI tools through external funding, e.g., grant funding, is typically reimbursable.

- A. **GW Information Technology (IT) Support:** Instructors should seek support from GW IT for classroom use of AI tools [3].
- B. **GWSB Finance Guidance:** Instructors should seek guidance from GWSB Finance for purchasing AI tools for classroom use.

3.3. Teaching and Grading Assistants

Instructors should provide clear guidance to grading and teaching assistants on the appropriate use of AI for their duties [3], ensuring students and assistants adhere to these guidelines.

3.4. Accessibility and Equity

- A. **Disability Support Services (DSS) Accommodations:** Instructors must honor approved accommodations provided by GW DSS. Digital assistive technologies (e.g., speech-to-text, screen readers, or cognitive aids) used as part of a documented accommodation are allowed [9].
- B. **Tool Equity and Data Privacy:**
 - i. AI-based assignments should be doable using GW-provided AI tools for students (e.g., Microsoft Copilot) or free public alternatives [8, 10].



- ii. AI-based assignments should not involve the use of GW-regulated data, GW-restricted data, or PII [1, 3, 8].

3.5. Clear Usage Policies for Students [2, 8]

Instructors should include a specific AI usage policy in their syllabi [2, 8]. If no policy is provided, the guidelines for students in Section 5 apply by default [2]. When deciding to prohibit AI tools, instructors should weigh educational benefits against job-readiness harms [8, 10]. See Section 6 for example syllabus statements.

3.6. Use of AI Tools for Grading

GW-provided AI tools may be used to aid instructors and assistants in grading.

- A. Instructors and assistants who use AI tools to aid in grading:
 - i. Are responsible for the assigned grades.
 - ii. Should review all assigned grades [1, 3].
 - iii. Should inform students of AI tool use in grading.
 - iv. Must protect student data and use GW-provided AI tools to process student data.
 - v. Must abide by grade review or appeal processes in syllabi, the George Washington University Code of Academic Integrity, or other applicable policies.
- B. Student data must be protected using anonymization, data removal, and GW-provided tools.
 - i. Student PII, including names, email addresses, or GWIDs, should be removed or anonymized before using AI tools for grading [1, 3].
 - ii. Student PII must only be processed when necessary by faculty using GW-provided Box AI [3, 6, 7].
- C. Any fully automated or non-reviewed use of AI for grading must be approved by the GWSB Dean's Office.

4. Guidelines for Researchers

4.1. Funder and Publisher AI Policies

Researchers must follow the AI policies of publications and funding agencies [5].

4.2. Reimbursement Guidelines [1, 3]

- A. **FSA Reimbursement:** P-Card purchase of AI tools for research is reimbursable in many cases.⁴
- B. **External Funding Reimbursement:** Purchase of AI tools through external funding, e.g., grant funding, is typically reimbursable.
- C. **GW Information Technology (IT) Support:** Investigators should seek support from GW IT for research use of AI tools [3].
- D. **GWSB Finance Guidance:** Investigators should seek guidance from GWSB Finance for research use of AI tools.

4.3. Graduate Students and Research Assistants

Researchers should provide clear guidance to students and assistants on the appropriate use of AI for their duties [3], ensuring students and assistants adhere to these guidelines.

4.4. Approval for Human Subjects

Researchers must secure approval (e.g., by the university's Institutional Review Board (IRB)) and informed consent for AI research involving human subjects and PII [1, 11, 12].

5. Guidelines for Students

5.1. Syllabus Policies on AI

Students must follow syllabus policies on AI tool use [2].

5.2. Default Guidelines for Students

If no syllabus policy is provided, the following student guidelines apply:

⁴ As of 04/2026, P-Card purchases of AI tools for research were authorized by the GWSB Dean's Office. See email "AI research tools and subscriptions," dated 10 April 2026 for additional details.

- A. **AI Tools for Assignments:** AI tools may be used to complete assignments submitted for evaluation (e.g., homework assignments), with disclosure, documentation, and credit for AI tools or AI-based sources.⁵
- B. **AI Tools for Assessments:** AI tools should not be used for assessments (e.g., quizzes, exams) [2].
- C. **AI Tools for Preliminary or Unsubmitted Work:** AI tools may be used for materials that are not submitted as assignments or assessments (e.g., studying, research, brainstorming).

6. Example Syllabus Policies

Example syllabus statements include:

- A. **General Prohibition on AI Tools:** By submitting work for evaluation in this course, you represent it as your own intellectual product. You may not submit for evaluation any content (e.g., ideas, text, code, images) that was generated, in whole or in part, by an AI tool. Doing so in this course constitutes cheating under the George Washington University Code of Academic Integrity [2]. Proper attribution or disclosure does not authorize AI tool use when the instructor has prohibited their use.
- B. **Selective Permission for AI Tools:** By submitting work for evaluation in this course, you represent it as your own intellectual product. You may not submit for evaluation any content (e.g., ideas, text, code, images) that was generated, in whole or in part, by an AI tool unless the instructor has explicitly granted permission to do so. Your instructor will explain to you the uses of AI tools that are permitted or prohibited in this course, including on what specific assignments AI tool use is permitted. Submitting content for evaluation that was produced in whole or in part by AI tools, except for the specific purpose(s) and assignment(s) discussed and authorized by the instructor, constitutes cheating in this course under the George Washington University Code of Academic

⁵ For purposes of this policy, *assignments* mean work submitted for course credit outside controlled testing conditions, e.g., homework, essays, projects, coding assignments, and presentations. *Assessment* means quizzes, exams, or other evaluative activities where unaided student performance is being tested, including take-home exams unless the instructor states otherwise.



Integrity [2]. Proper attribution or disclosure does not authorize AI tool use when the instructor has prohibited their use.

- C. **General Permission for AI Tools:** You are permitted to use AI tools to generate content submitted for evaluation in this course. You may also use AI tools to help generate ideas and brainstorm. You remain responsible for all content you submit for evaluation. If you include content (e.g., ideas, text, code, images) that was generated, in whole or in part, by an AI tool in work submitted for evaluation in this course, you must document and credit your source. Failure to do so in this course constitutes failure to attribute under the George Washington University Code of Academic Integrity [2].

7. Policy Review and Revision

AI is an evolving technology, and this policy may be revised from time to time in response to changes in GW policies or technological developments. It will also be reviewed at a regular cadence.

- A. **Review Cadence:** This policy should be reviewed biennially (every 2 years) and revised as necessary.
- B. **Review Personnel:** Review is conducted by the GWSB Dean's Office or the Chief AI Officer.
- C. **Scheduled Review:** The next policy review is scheduled for 08/2028.
- D. **Revision Table:** Substantive revisions should be recorded in Table 1.

Date (MM/YYYY)	Reviewer(s)	Summary of Revisions
04/2026	Patrick Hall, Sevin Yeltekin	N/A, initial public draft.
07/2026	Patrick Hall	Revised to reflect initial public draft feedback.

Table 1. Substantive revisions.



8. GW Policy and Guidance References

No.	Title	Date (MM/YYYY)
1	Privacy Guidance for Use of AI	N/A
2	GenAI Guidelines	04/2023
3	AI Guidance and Best Practices	N/A
4	Additional GenAI Guidance	08/2023
5	Acceptable Use of IT Resources Policy	09/2023
6	Artificial Intelligence (AI) Evaluation & Status	N/A
7	Data Classification Guide	N/A
8	Teaching with Generative AI	N/A
9	Disability Policy	04/2026
10	Deciding on Appropriate Use of GenAI in Academic Classes	05/2025
11	Cybersecurity Risk Policy	10/2023
12	Research Involving Human Participants Policy	11/2006

Table 2. Table of GW policy references.